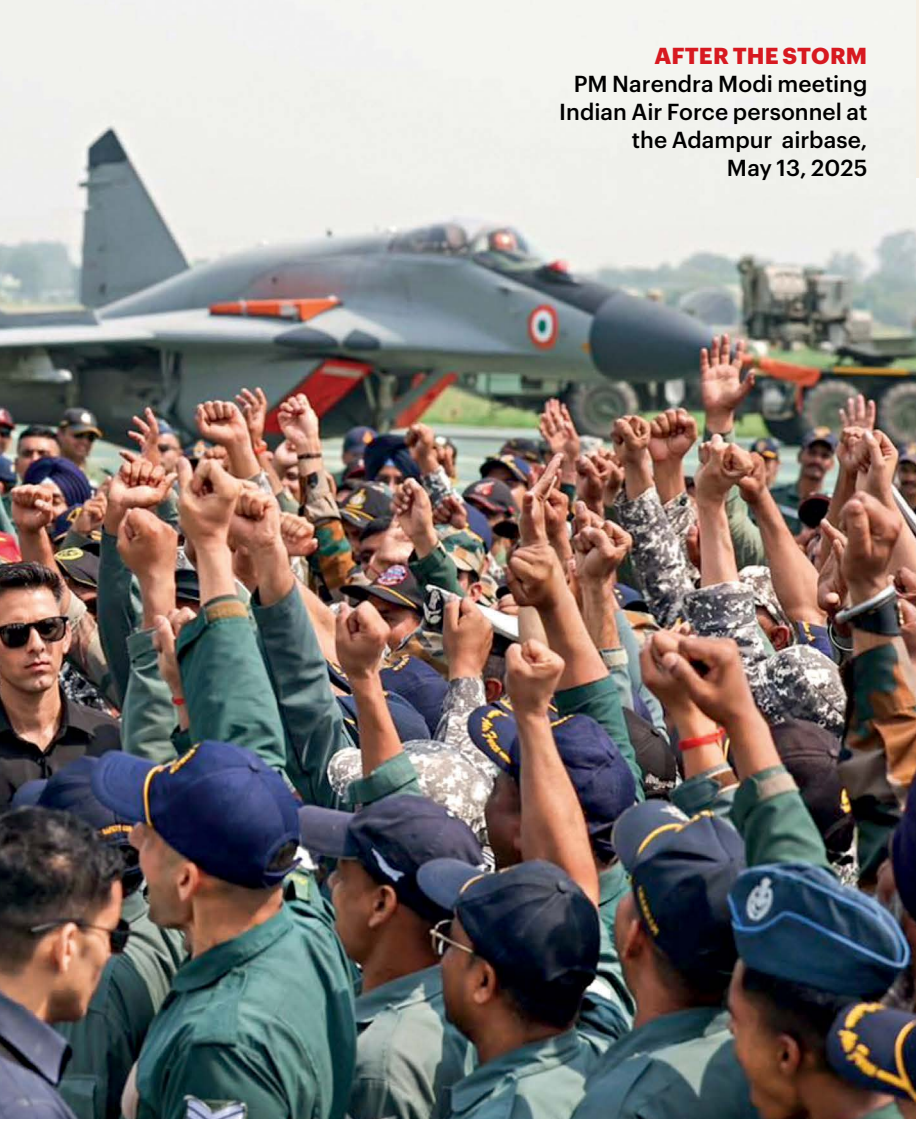


AFTER THE STORM
PM Narendra Modi meeting Indian Air Force personnel at the Adampur airbase, May 13, 2025

Fire from the Skies

- **On May 7, Indian missiles, bombs, long-range artillery destroyed nine Jaish-e-Mohammed and Lashkar-e-Toiba camps in Pakistan**
- **India's layered air defence networks shot down most Pakistani drones/ missiles**
- **After Pakistani defence radars were neutralised, Indian BrahMos and SCALP missiles wreaked havoc on eight Pakistani air bases**
- **Op. Sindoor ushered in a new security threshold: any terrorist attack will now be treated as an act of war. It boosted confidence in indigenous defence technology**

multi-layered air defence (AD) system, bolstered by such weapons as indigenous Akash surface to air missiles (SAM) and the Russian origin S-400 long-range SAM, destroyed them mid-flight. The effectiveness of the IAF's Integrated Air Command and Control System (IACCS) and the Army's Akashteer was a positive emerging from the conflict. Though after the assault on the terror bases Pakistani fighter jets posed a threat, they were driven from the skies after Indian missile strikes took out Pakistani air defence radars on May 8 and 10. Thereafter, Pakistan was helpless before India's barrage of SCALP and BrahMos missiles on eight Pakistani air bases. Thus chastened, Pakistan called for a ceasefire. Pakistan claimed to have shot down several Indian fighter jets, and the Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan later acknowledged "initial losses". IAF chief Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh has stated that five Pakistani fighters and one large aircraft were downed by Indian attacks.

Op. Sindoor gained powerful emotional significance when two senior female officers—Colonel Sofiya Qureshi and Wing Commander Vyomika Singh—led media briefings, embodying national pride and unity. The operation reinforced India's zero-tolerance stance against terrorism and highlighted Pakistan's continued sheltering of militant networks. Unlike the single-day Balakot strike, this mission unfolded over 87 hours, and showcased India's ability to conduct operations without provoking full-scale war. The Army, IAF and Navy operated in seamlessly coordinated roles. The success of the mission boosted confidence in indigenous defence technology and accelerated investment in drones, artificial intelligence and hypersonic systems critical for future warfare.

Operation Sindoor highlighted the need for future-ready tech in warfare, and led to accelerated investment in AI and hypersonic systems

The operation has established a new security threshold: any terrorist attack on India will now be treated as an act of war and will be met with calculated and punitive force. Indeed, as India's political and military leaders have said, Op. Sindoor is not over. Since Sindoor, infiltration across the LoC has declined, raising hopes for the revival of tourism in regions like Pahalgam.

Op. Sindoor now stands as a milestone in the country's military history—an assertion of strength, sovereignty and unwavering national resolve. ■